

ANIME

Jujutsu Kaisen 0

★★★★☆ | Jujutsu Kaisen 0 features Yuta Okkotsu as the main protagonist. Yuta's backstory might feel very cookie-cutter generic for anime protagonists to most. His powers are also poorly defined and kind of overpowered especially towards the latter portion of the movie. Although it is still nice to see a deviation from the "technique-based" fighting styles that all the other characters in the series have. However when a movie's standard plot involves friendship, tragic backstories, and fairytale resolutions, it becomes terribly repetitious and uninteresting. Coming from Mappa Studios the animations were absolutely top-notch and crisp and a pleasure to watch. The fight scenes



are really well drawn, which is pretty much a major reason to consider this movie. However, overall the movie juggles between mid-tier animation and great camera pans.

The soundtracks from the movie are pretty good and suit most of the scenes throughout the story. They

compliment the ambience but there could have been a better attempt on making the tracks remarkable or nostalgic to the original series. The track around the beginning is one of the best ones in this regard.

As a prequel to the original series, the movie captures Maki and the other second-year students as first-year students, and their initial impressions of Yuta, and casts light on the growth of the characters. Additionally, as the movie progresses into its final major showdown, most of the Kyoto students also show up. The only let down in terms of characters is the MC. He feels a bit too lifeless for someone who just so happens to have the most influence in the film. His character development is not very steady either, making it hard to connect to him as an audience. Also, for someone watching the movie before the series, it can be a little hard to grab hold of so many characters and their weight in the story as they keep dropping in with every other scene.

—Nayan Panda

COMIC

The Bone Orchard: The Passageway

★★★★☆ | If there's one word to describe Jeff Lemire, it would be versatile. The man can write just about anything. From superhero tales to gut-wrenching horror and everything in between, Lemire's work stands out from the glut of substandard comics by giving the reader stories that are definitely worth the cover price. He first shot to fame with his work on Sweettooth, which has been adapted into a semi-successful yet tainted show on Netflix and has since been plying his trade working for Marvel and DC, with the occasional creator-owned work for Image comics. His latest book, The Bone Orchard: The



Passageway is a return to the mind-bending, existential horror first seen in Gideon Falls. The book is illustrated by frequent collaborator Andrea Sorrentino and his art adds a whole new dimension of dread and terror to the story. It begins with a geologist making his way to a

deserted island to study a mysterious phenomenon. What he finds there will take him to the darkest recesses of his nightmares. There's a hole in the ground that seems to have no end but it's alive, somehow, and it wants to feed. Readers will find comparisons to the works of H.P. Lovecraft.

Lemire carefully crafts a tale of loss, terror and ultimately hopelessness as Sorrentino's artwork acts as a nail driven through the reader's skull. The Bone Orchard: The Passageway shared more in common with something like the Twilight Zone as it presents different stories that are sort of set in the same nightmarish universe. If you're a fan of intelligent and subtle horror, the likes of which hacks like Jordan Peele wish they could achieve, you should definitely check out The Bone Orchard: The Passageway. And even if you're not a fan of the genre, you should still read it simply because it's a great story complemented by evocative and expressive art.

—Andrew Lu